قطاف الزيتون

qtaaf iz-zeetoun

The Olive Harvest



اللهجة الفلسطينية — القدس

Spoken Palestinian (Jerusalem). No fus7a, no tashkeel.

Before you start

A day on the family's land, picking olives with Seedo and Teta. From here on the chat alphabet changes slightly — and you meet ممكن / لازم / بدّي, the three words that let a verb drop its بـ altogether.

THE CHAT ALPHABET — UPDATED KEY

7	ح	hard breathy H
5	خ	kh
3	ع	ayn
2	ء	glottal stop *only* — hamza
8	غ	French-style r
q	ق	written q now, not 2 — though in Jerusalem speech it's *said* as a glottal stop

ON THE LAND

أرض	*ard*	land, a plot of land
شجرة زيتون	*shajarit zeetoun*	an olive tree · pl. شجر زيتون
سلة	*salle*	basket · pl. سلال salaal
زيت	*zeet*	oil
قطف	*qataf*	he picked (olives, fruit)
معصرة	*ma3sara*	the press, where the oil is made

New grammar, in one line. After بدّي (want), لازم (must) and ممكن (can), the next verb loses its بـ: بدي أروح, not بدي بروح. Full pattern in the notes at the back.



الصبح بدري، طلعت عيلة سامي عالأرض يلي بره القدس، وين شجر الزيتون يلي زرعه سيدو من زمان.

سيدو قال وهو بيفرغ السلال من السيارة:

«اليوم لازم نقطف الزيتون كله قبل ما تبلش الشتوية.»

سامي حابب يساعد بس ما بيعرف يقطف، فسأل:

«سيدو، كيف بدي أمسك الغصن؟»

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is-sob7 badri, tal3at 3eelit Saami 3al-ard yalli barra il-quds, ween shajar iz-zeetoun yalli zar3o Seedo min zamaan.
Seedo 2aal w-huwwe byfarrigh is-salaal min is-sayyaara:
“il-yom laazim niqtaf iz-zeetoun killo qabel ma tballish ish-shitwiyye.”
Saami 7aabib ysaa3id bass ma by3ref yiqtaf, fa-so2al:
“Seedo, keef biddi amsik il-8osn?”

Early in the morning, Sami's family went out to the land outside Jerusalem, where the olive trees Grandpa planted long ago stand. Grandpa said while unloading the baskets from the car: "Today we have to pick all the olives before the rains start." Sami wants to help but doesn't know how to pick, so he asked: "Grandpa, how do I hold the branch?"



سيدو ضحك وقاله: «مش صعبة يا سيدي. حط ايدك تحت الغصن، وامسك الزيتونة برفق، ولفها لحد ما تطيح.»

سامي جرب مرة، مرتين... وبالثالثة طاحت زيتونة بايده!

صرخ: «سيدو! قطفتها! شفتها كيف طاحت؟»

Seedo di7ik w-2aallo: “mish sa3be ya seedi. 7ott eedak ta7t il-8osn, w-imsik iz-zatoune bi-rifq, w-liffha la7ad ma titee7.”
Saami jarrab marra, marrtein... w-bit-taalte tta7et zatoune bi-eedo!
sara5: “Seedo! qataftha! shiftha keef tta7et?”

Grandpa laughed and said to him: "It's not hard, my dear. Put your hand under the branch, hold the olive gently, and twist it until it falls." Sami tried once, twice... and on the third try an olive fell into his hand! He shouted: "Grandpa! I picked it! Did you see how it fell?"



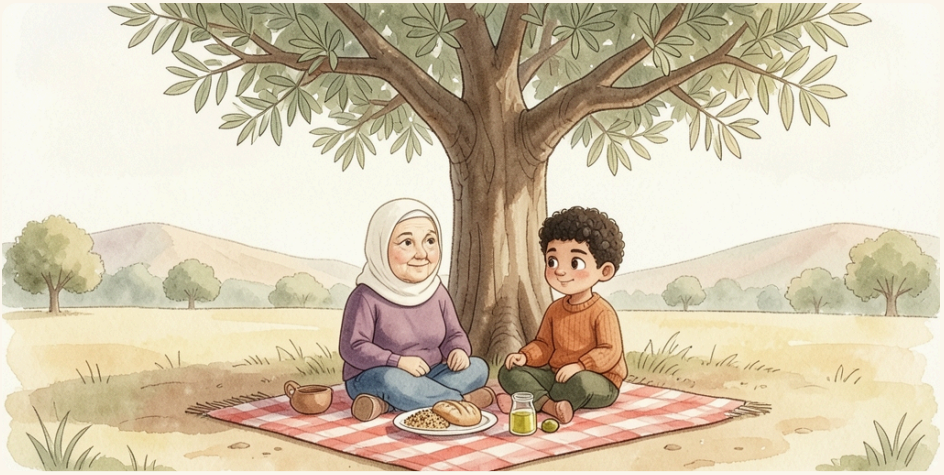
تيتا وسامي قعدوا يقطفوا سوا، وحطوا الزيتون بالسلال شوي شوي.

تيتا قالت: «شايف؟ لما نشتغل مع بعض، السلال بتمتلي أسرع!»

بعد شوي صارت عندهم أربع سلال مليانة، وسامي كان مبسوط منهم كتير.

Teta w-Saami 23adu yiqtafu sawa, w-7attu iz-zeetoun bis-salaal shwayy shwayy.
Teta 2aalat: "shaayef? lamma nishta8el ma3 ba3d, is-salaal btimtili asra3!"
ba3d shwayy saarat 3andhom arba3 salaal malyaane, w-Saami kaan mabsout minhom kteer.

Grandma and Sami sat picking together, filling the baskets with olives bit by bit. Grandma said: "See? When we work together, the baskets fill up faster!" After a while they had four full baskets, and Sami was very pleased with them.



لما تعبوا، قعدوا تحت شجرة كبيرة ياكلوا.

تيتا فتحت الكيس وقالت: «تعال كل يا سيدي، جبتلك خبز وزعتر وزيتون.»

سامي قال: «تيتا، عطيني شوية خبز كمان، وحطيلي زيت زيادة فوقه!»

تيتا ضحكت وعطته الخبز وقالت: «كول صحتين، بس خلي مكان للعصير كمان!»

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lamma ti3bu, 23adu ta7t shajara kbeere yaklu.
Teta fata7et il-kees w-2aalat: "ta3aal kool ya seedi, jibtillak 5ubez w-za3tar w-zeetoun."
Saami 2aal: "Teta, 3atteeni shwayyet 5ubez kamaan, w-7attili zeet ziyaade foqo!"
Teta di7ket w-3atetto il-5ubez w-2aalat: "kool sa7tein, bass 5alli makaan lil-3aseer kamaan!"

When they got tired, they sat under a big tree to eat. Grandma opened the bag and said: "Come and eat, my dear, I brought you bread, za'tar, and olives." Sami said: "Grandma, give me a bit more bread, and put extra oil on top for me!" Grandma laughed, handed him the bread, and said: "Enjoy — but leave room for the juice too!"



بعد الأكل، سيدو قرب من شجرة طويلة وقال:

«هاي الشجرة أطول من الباقي، بدي السلم.»

سامي قال: «سيدو، ممكن أمسكلك السلم وانت طالع؟»

سيدو ابتسم وقال: «أكيد، بس خلي بالك منيح، هاي الشغلة مش لعبة.»

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ba3d il-akel, Seedo qarrab min shajara tawiile w-2aal:
"hayy ish-shajara atwal min il-baaqi, biddi is-sillim."
Saami 2aal: "Seedo, mumkin amsiklak is-sillim w-inte taale3?"
Seedo ibtasam w-2aal: "akiid, bass 5alli baalak mnee7, hayy ish-shu8le mish li3be."

After eating, Grandpa went up to a tall tree and said: "This tree is taller than the rest, I need the ladder." Sami said: "Grandpa, can I hold the ladder for you while you climb?" Grandpa smiled and said: "Sure, but pay close attention, this job isn't a game."



لما خلصوا، حملوا السلال كلها عالبيكب ورايحين عالمعصرة.

سيدو قال: «هلق بدنا نحول الزيتون لزيت. هاد الشغل بياخد وقت، بس النتيجة بتستاهل.»

سامي شاف المعصرة أول مرة، والزيت الأخضر طالع من المكبس، فسأل:

«سيدو، من وين جاي هالريحة الحلوة؟»

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lamma khallasu, 7amalu is-salaal killha 3al-bikab w-raay7een 3al-ma3sara.
Seedo 2aal: "hala2 biddna ni7awwil iz-zeetoun la-zeet. haad ish-shu8ul byaakhod waqt, bass in-nateeje bitistaahal."
Saami shaaf il-ma3sara awwal marra, w-iz-zeet il-a5dar taale3 min il-makbas, fa-so2al: "Seedo, min ween jaay hal-ree7a il-7ilwe?"

When they finished, they loaded all the baskets onto the pickup and headed to the press. Grandpa said: "Now we turn the olives into oil. This work takes time, but the result is worth it." Sami saw the press for the first time, with green oil coming out of it, so he asked: "Grandpa, where's this lovely smell coming from?"



بالليل، رجعوا عالبيت وايديهم لسا فيها ريحة الزيتون.

تيتا حطت زيت جديد وزعتر عالطاولة، وقالت: «هاد أول زيت هالموسم، غمسوا فيه خبز وقولوا شو رأيكم.»

سيدو نظر لسامي وقال: «هاي الأرض من جدي لأبوي، ومن أبوي إلي، وبكرة رح تصير إلك انت. خليك دايما قريب منها.»

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bil-leel, riji3u 3al-beet w-eedeehom lissa fiiha ree7et iz-zeetoun.
Teta 7attet zeet jdeed w-za3tar 3at-taawle, w-2aalat: "haad awwal zeet hal-mawsim, 8amsu fii 5ubez w-2oulu shu ra2ykom."
Seedo nazar la-Saami w-2aal: "hayy il-ard min jiddi la-abouy, w-min abouy ili, w-bukra ra7 tseer ilak inte. 5alleek daayman qariib minha."

At night, they went back home, their hands still smelling of olives. Grandma put fresh oil and za'tar on the table and said: "This is the first oil of this season, dip some bread in it and tell me what you think." Grandpa looked at Sami and said: "This land came from my grandfather to my father, and from my father to me, and one day it will be yours. Always stay close to it."

Words from this story

Land, trees, and the work of picking.

يلي	*yalli*	who, which, that — the all-purpose relative
الشتوية	*ish-shitwiyye*	the rainy season, "the cold months"
حابب	*7aabib*	wanting to, would like to · f. حابة 7aabbe
برفق	*bi-rifq*	gently
طاح / تطيح	*taa7 / titee7*	to fall — not وقع
مليانة	*malyaane*	full (f.) · m. مليان malyaan
زعتر	*za3tar*	the herb mix — also the plant itself
عطيني	*3atteeni*	give me
حطيلي	*7attili*	put ... for me
زيادة	*ziyaade*	extra, more (of something)

Words from this story · continued

باقي	*baaqi*	the rest, what's left
خلي بالك	*5alli baalak*	pay attention, watch out
مش لعبة	*mish li3be*	it's not a game — take it seriously
معصرة	*ma3sara*	the press, where oil is made
بتستاهل	*bitistaahal*	it's worth it
موسم	*mawsim*	season (harvest season, in context)
غمسوا	*8amsu*	dip! (pl. imperative) · غمس 8amas to dip
بكرة	*bukra*	tomorrow — or "one day", in the future
من ... لـ	*min ... la*	from ... to — for a chain: من جدي لأبوي

Dialect notes

Verbs that drop their بـ, and how to hook a person onto a verb.

1 · بدّي / لازم / ممكن + BARE PRESENT

After these three, the next verb loses its بـ — almost like English "to" + verb:

بدي	*biddi*	I want (to)
بدك	*biddak / biddik*	you want (m. / f.)
بدو	*biddo*	he wants
بدها	*bidha*	she wants
بدنا	*bidna*	we want
بدكم	*bidkom*	you (pl.) want
بدهم	*bidhom*	they want

لازم and ممكن never change form: لازم تروح *laazim trou7* you must go · ممكن نيجي *mumkin niji* we could come.

2 · HOOKING A PERSON ONTO THE VERB

عطيني	*3atteeni*	give me
حطيلي	*7attili*	put … for me
جبتلك	*jibtillak*	I brought (it) for you
قطفتها	*qataftha*	I picked it (f.)
عطته	*3atetto*	she gave him/it

Dialect notes · continued

3 · COMPARING THINGS

Put أ on the front of most adjectives to compare, and say من for "than":
طويل *tawiil* tall → أطول *atwal* taller · حلو *7ilu* nice → أحلى *a7la* nicer · كبير *kbiir* big → أكبر *akbar* bigger.
هاي الشجرة أطول من الباقي *hayy ish-shajara atwal min il-baaqi* — this tree is taller than the rest.

> **Where to go next.** Re-read the story out loud, then retell it using only بدّي / لازم / ممكن — describe what Sami wants, what he has to do, and what he's allowed to do. That's harder than it sounds, and it's exactly what the exercise page asks for.

Now you try

Use بدّي / لازم / ممكن and the attached pronouns from this book. Don't peek at the answers until you've had a go.

1 · FILL THE GAP

١. أنا ___ أروح عالأرض بكرة *(I want to)*

٢. ___ تحط ايدك تحت الغصن قبل ما تقطف *(You must)*

٣ ___ تساعدني بالسلة؟ *(Can you…?)*

٤. هاي الشجرة ___ من الباقي *(taller)*

2 · TRANSLATE INTO DIALECT

١) Give me the bread, please.

٢) I saw it (the olive) fall.

٣) Can I hold the ladder for you?

٤) This land is bigger than ours.

Answers. 1) ٢ — أطول · ممكن · لازم · بدي) عطيني الخبز لو سمحت. · شفتها لما طاحت. · هاي الأرض أكبر من أرضنا. · ممكن أمسكلك السلم؟